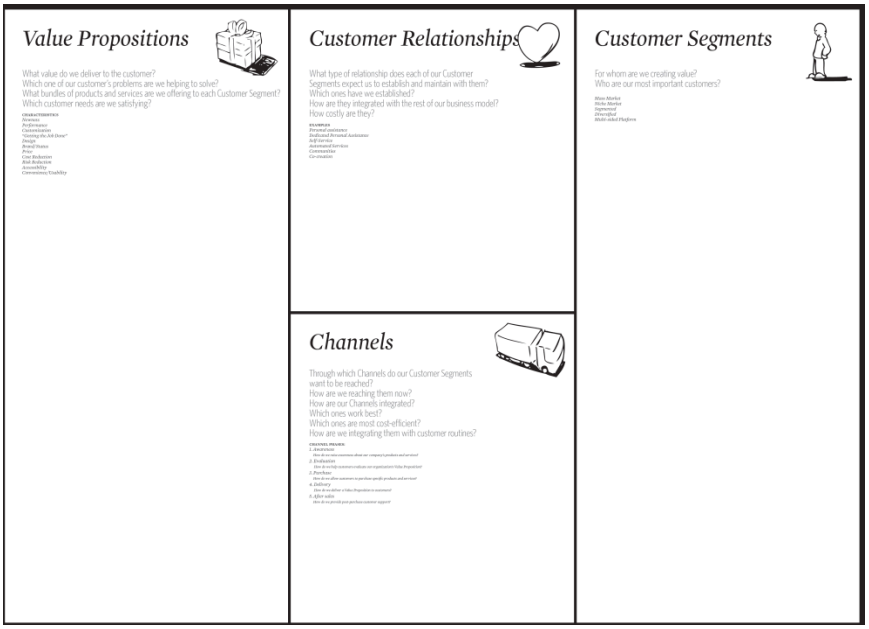
Competitive Analysis

The following form is designed to help you identify potential competitive products or services that currently exist in the market or are being developed by competitors. The information below is a recap from our class discussion on filling out the Business Model Canvas. Please refer to this guide in filling out the Competitive Product Form.

Competitors

Who Is A Competitor?

- Competitors provide solutions for the same problem your technology or product is seeking to solve.
  - A competitive product could solve the same problem in a completely different way.
  - Ex. Your technology is a cell phone app that allows donors to give money directly to their favorite charities, reminds donors if they have not donated in a while, and allows charities to send targeted messages to potential donors. Your competitors could include websites that allow people to donate to one or many charities, the United Way which takes in money and distributes it to the charity a donor chooses, and call centers that formulate lists of potential donors and contact them on a charity's behalf.
- It is important to understand that some competitors may also be potential customers.
  - Search for and document contact information from customers in order to contact them about their products.



Product Features

Identify competitive products or services and its features.

- What is the competitive product or service value proposition?
  - What do they brag about on their website: faster, bigger, cheaper, etc?
- Who buys the competitive product or service?
- How long has the competitor company been selling its products or services?

Product Comparison

Now compare these products or services to your product or service.

- Compare your value propositions
  - If they're faster, research whether or not speed is important to end users
- What makes your product different from the competition?
  - Have you discovered a new and easier way to solve an old problem?
- Is there any way that you can differentiate your product even more?
  - Easier to use than existing competition?
  - Less expensive than existing competition?

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Helpful Hints

Key Resources

- **Week 5 Competitive Products PowerPoint** (in Basecamp; listen to the recording)

- **Steve Blank's Lecture 1.5 A and Lecture 1.5B: "Business Models and Customer Development" and Lecture 2: "Value Proposition"**

- **Finding Competitive Products**
  - Look through customer interview notes
  - Ask your customers "how do you do this process today?"
  - Search on Google – look at websites and forums
  - Market research databases
  - Competitors of competitors – who your competitors list on their websites or what comes up when you Google a competitor's name
  -

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Understanding Competitors

Identify at least five competitors and their products/services. List the competitive product's features and (if possible) prices, and then differentiate how your product has an OBJECTIVE advantage over the existing product or how it is an improvement on the existing competition. Quantify your value as much as you can. Remember, think creatively to come up with 5 alternative solutions to your offering!

Competitor:	*Product Type:*	*Product Name:*
Product Features (e.g. Cost, Performance, Convenience, Reliability):		
What makes your product better or different?		

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